DESIGN DOCUMENT · V1 · 25 OCT 2026

Decision criteria and system flow.

How Frictionless reads franchise applications, scores every partner out of 100, gives each territory slot to the best partner, and explains the decision — with every rule, weight and threshold the engine uses.

01 What Frictionless does
02 System flow — the swimlane
03 Inputs: the two trigger choices and three sheets
04 Reading messy data
05 Decision pipeline — step by step
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NUMBERS SHOWN FOR RUBRIC V2 AND THE BRAND PROFILE “EYEWEAR & OPTICAL · FOFO”. THEY CHANGE WHEN THE BRAND OR THE RUBRIC CHANGES.

Every application, decided — with a reason.

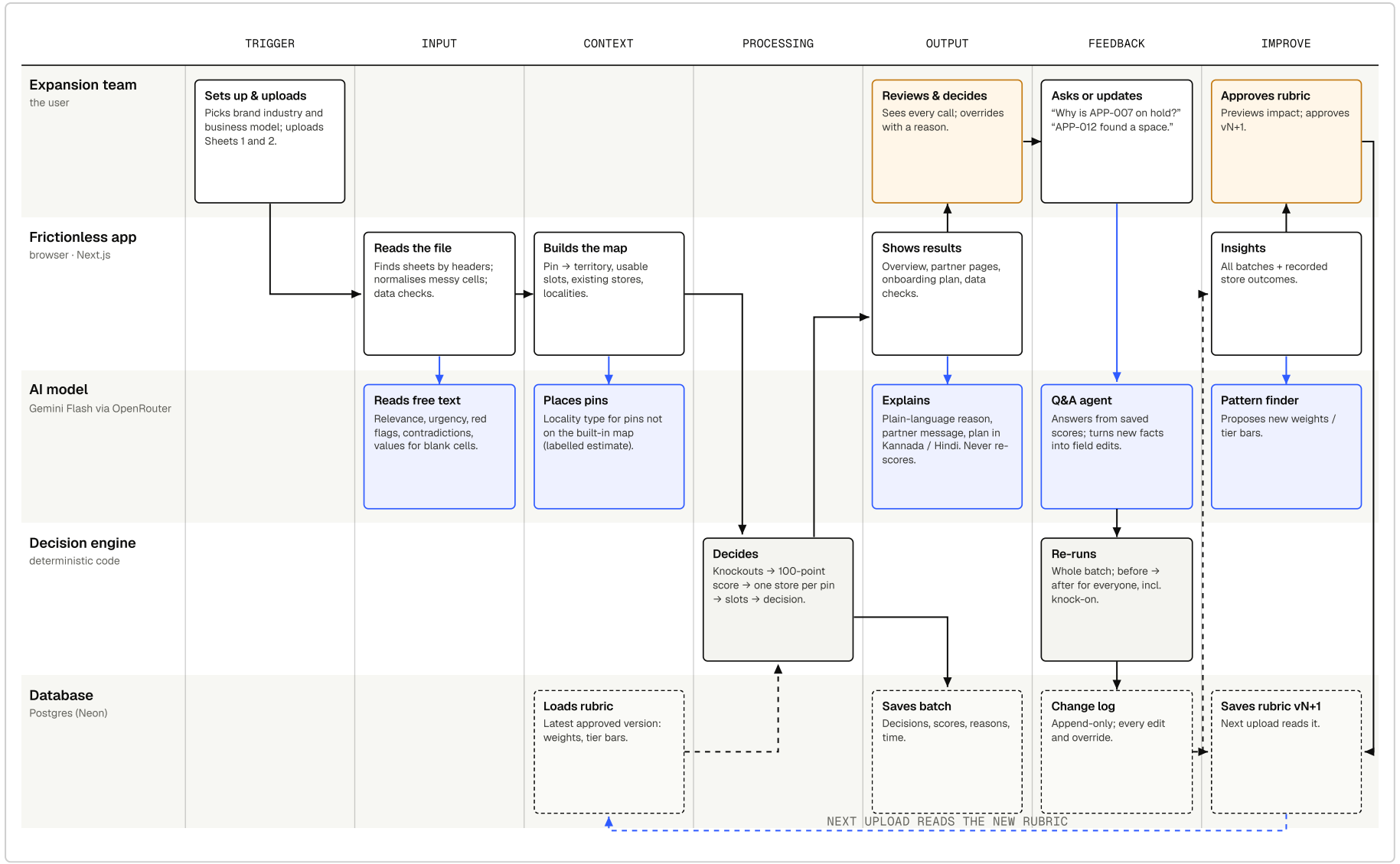
The expansion team picks the brand's industry and business model and uploads the applications and territories sheets. For every partner Frictionless returns **Approve, Conditional, Hold or Reject**, the reason, the conditions to close, who they competed with, a simulated “path to yes”, and a dated onboarding plan in the partner's language. The team can then ask why, or give new information and see exactly who moves before anything is saved.

Design principles

The engine decides; the AI never scores	Decisions come from deterministic code — the same file always gives the same answer. The AI reads messy text, explains, translates and turns chat into edits.
Data problems → Hold, not Reject	A blank amount or a city/pin conflict costs the partner one question, not their application.
One store per pin, always	Existing stores included. Usable slots are capped by pins that are still free.
Best partner wins the slot	A strong runner-up for a pin is re-scored on a free pin in the same territory instead of being thrown away.
The team decides	Overrides need a reason; rubric changes are previewed and approved as new versions; every change is logged and undoable.
Rubric v2	Adds “Competitors nearby” to location fit. Location keeps its 45 points: strategic fit 25 → 20 and supply-chain reach 15 → 10 (of the location weights) make room for competitors at 10.
Show raw values, not just scores	“₹18L vs Tier 3 minimum ₹20L (0.90×) · batch median ₹30L” — every number is traceable.

Decision vocabulary

APPROVE	Wins a slot and scores ≥ the tier bar (T1 70 · T2 66 · T3 62), nothing left to close.
CONDITIONAL	Wins a slot (score ≥ 55) but has conditions — no space yet, funding gap, relocation. Slot held 60 days.
ON HOLD	Score 45–55, waitlisted behind better partners, outside the plan, or missing data.
REJECT	Score under 45, or failed a knockout above.



App step · AI step · Decision engine · Database · Decision gate — the team decides · - - → AI handoff / next upload

FIG. 01 · WHO DOES WHAT, FROM UPLOAD TO AN IMPROVED RUBRIC. THE BUILD TOOL (CLAUDE CODE) WROTE THE CODE AND IS NEVER USED WHILE THE APP RUNS.

Two choices and three sheets.

Before uploading, the team chooses the brand's **industry** and **business model**. Together they set every brand-specific number in the rubric: how much a partner must invest per city tier, the right space size, whether walk-ins (and so the ground floor) matter, which past businesses count as relevant, lead times and the training plan.

Industry presets

INDUSTRY	PARTNER CAPITAL T1 / T2 / T3	IDEAL SQ FT	WALK-IN RELIANCE	GROUND FLOOR NEEDED	LEAD TIME (SPACE / NONE)	STAFF
Eyewear & optical	₹35L / ₹25L / ₹20L	250-600	high	yes	2 / 4 mo	4
Food & QSR / café	₹40L / ₹32L / ₹25L	300-600	high	yes	2 / 4 mo	8
Apparel & footwear	₹45L / ₹35L / ₹28L	800-1200	high	yes	2 / 4 mo	5
Grocery & convenience	₹30L / ₹24L / ₹18L	600-1000	medium	yes	2 / 3 mo	6
Pharmacy & health	₹20L / ₹16L / ₹12L	250-500	medium	yes	2 / 3 mo	3
Beauty & wellness	₹30L / ₹24L / ₹18L	600-900	medium	no	2 / 4 mo	6
Mobiles & electronics	₹40L / ₹32L / ₹25L	400-700	high	yes	2 / 3 mo	4
Logistics & last-mile	₹15L / ₹12L / ₹10L	1200-2500	low	yes	1 / 3 mo	10
Education & learning	₹25L / ₹20L / ₹15L	900-1500	medium	no	2 / 4 mo	6

Business models

BUSINESS MODEL	WHAT IT CHANGES
FOFO Franchise-owned, franchise-operated. Partner invests and runs the store.	Partner invests and runs it. All weights as listed.
FOCO Franchise-owned, company-operated. Partner invests; the brand runs the store.	Brand runs it: operating-experience weight halves and moves to financial readiness; capital +10%; margin ×0.75 (revenue share).
Shop-in-shop / kiosk Small brand corner inside the partner's existing shop.	Brand corner inside the partner's shop: space ≈ ¼, capital ×0.3, 2 staff, needs a running shop (else a major gap).

BUSINESS MODEL	WHAT IT CHANGES
Micro-partner Partner lends space and time (Amazon I Have Space style). Very low capex.	Partner lends space (I Have Space style): 120–300 sq ft, capital ×0.12, needs a running shop.
Other (free text)	AI picks the closest preset and adjusts the numbers; the team reviews them before upload.

The sheets

SHEET	COLUMNS READ	NOTES
1 · Applications	Application ID · Applicant name · City · State · Pin code · Investment capacity (₹ lakh) · Retail experience (years) · Current / past business · Space available · Space size (sq ft) · Floor · Target launch (months) · Preferred language · Notes from applicant	Columns matched by meaning; “City · State · Pin code” may be one column.
2 · Territories	Territory ID · City · State · Pin codes covered · City tier · Open slots · Priority	Pins linked to applications by pin code.
3 · Existing stores	Store ID · City · Pin code · Opened (year)	Fixed 10 stores, built in if the sheet is absent.

Messy cells are read, not rejected.

COLUMN	EXAMPLES ACCEPTED	READ AS
IDs	“app 7”, “APP_07”, “ter1”	APP-007, TER-01 (chat uses the same rule)
Names	“ RAVI KUMAR ”, “N/A”, “test”	Ravi Kumar; placeholders → blank
City	“Mysore”, “B'lore”, “Tumkur”, “ಮೈಸೂರು”, pin inside the city cell	Canonical city; pin extracted
Investment	“Rs 25,00,000”, “1.2 cr”, “30-35”, “15 lakh”, “approx 40”, 0	₹25L · ₹120L · ₹30L (lower end) · ₹15L · ₹40L · missing
Experience	“8+”, “fresher”, “6 months”, “two”	8 · 0 · 0.5 · 2
Space	“Yes - rented”, “own building (not mortgaged)”, “Rented (owner is my uncle)”, “looking for a shop”, “Yes”	Rented · Owned · Rented · Not yet identified · Hold (owned or rented?)
Floor	“GF”, “first floor ok”, “basement”, “Mall”	Ground · Upper · Upper (low visibility) · Mall unit
Target launch	“ASAP”, “Jan 2027”, “before Diwali”, “1 year”, 0	1 · months to Jan · 1 (8 Nov 2026) · 12 · 1
Language	“Kannada / English”, “ಕನ್ನಡ”, “Telugu”	Kannada (first listed) · Kannada · English default + warning
Pins (Sheet 2)	“570 001 & 570002 / 570008”, “572101-03”	570001, 570002, 570008 · 572101–572103
Tier / priority / slots	“Tier-II”, “T3” · “P1”, “HIGH!!”, “med” · “two”, “2 slots”	Tier 2, Tier 3 · High, High, Medium · 2, 2

Values read from the notes

If a cell is blank but the applicant's own text states it (“our 520 sq ft ground-floor shop”, “can invest 22 lakh”), the value is used, marked “from notes”, and a single condition asks the team to confirm it before signing.

Data checks

CHECK	EFFECT
Investment blank or 0; space status blank or “Yes”; pin missing or not 6 digits	ON HOLD Needs information
City and pin disagree (Mysuru with 560xxx)	ON HOLD with the exact question; never rejected on a location the applicant may not mean
Notes contradict the form (“still looking for a shop” while Space = Owned)	ON HOLD Needs clarification, quoting the notes. Softer conflicts read by the AI become a “confirm” condition.
Same name and pin as another row	ON HOLD Duplicate — merge first; never given a second slot
No space but size/floor filled	Treated as not identified; floor read as a preference only
Space owned/rented but size blank	Condition: confirm the carpet area
Territory: pin in two territories · tier contradicts allowed values · slots more than free pins · pin in wrong city	Counted once for the higher priority · official tier used · slots capped · flagged
Fields corrected later by the team	Older notes can no longer contradict them

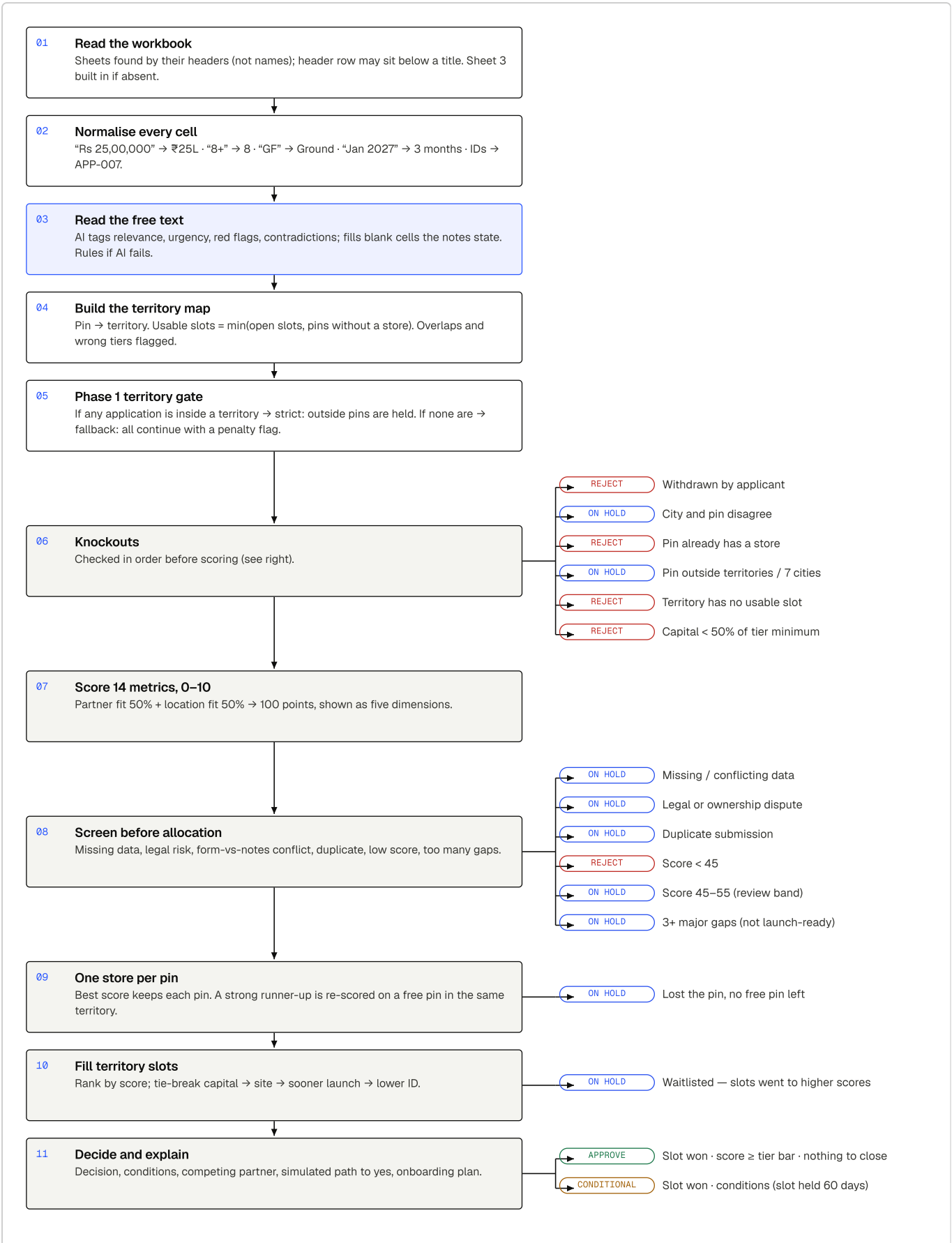


FIG. 02 · THE ORDER THE ENGINE RUNS IN. GREY STEPS ARE DETERMINISTIC CODE; THE BLUE STEP USES AI WITH A RULE-BASED FALLBACK. OUTCOMES ON THE RIGHT END THE PATH FOR THAT APPLICATION.

Phase 1 territory gate

Scenario A — strict. If at least one application in the batch is in a preferred territory, only in-territory applications go on to slots; the others are held on the waitlist as “outside the expansion area” (they still get a score so the team can see latent demand).
Scenario B — fallback. If none are, nobody is held back: every application continues with the flag “Not a preferred location for company”, a strategic-fit score of 2/10, and a condition that the team must open a territory.

Knockouts (in this order)

1. **Data checks** — Blank amount, city/pin mismatch, notes that contradict the form → Hold for one answer.
2. **Pin already has a store** — Never two stores in one pin → Reject, with nearby open pins suggested.
3. **Pin outside every territory** — → Hold on the waitlist (if any application in the batch is inside the plan).
4. **No usable slot** — Territory has 0 open slots, or every pin is already served → Reject.
5. **Capital too low** — Under 50% of the tier setup cost → Reject.

Five dimensions, fourteen metrics.

Each metric is scored 0–10. Partner fit (7 metrics) and location fit (7 metrics) are each weighted to 100 and blended 50/50. The result is shown as five dimensions so the reason is easy to read.

DIMENSION	QUESTION IT ANSWERS	METRICS	POINTS
Money	Can they pay for it, and will it pay back?	Financial readiness, Real-estate economics	17.5
Site readiness	Is there a space that fits the format?	Floor & accessibility, Space size & format fit, Space ownership	15
Operator	Can they run the store day to day?	Operating experience, Local nuance & intent	17.5
Location fit	Is this a place the brand wants to be?	Strategic fit & slots, Demographic density, Purchase triggers (JTBD), Supply-chain reach, Own-store overlap, Competitors nearby	45
Launch realism	How soon can they realistically open?	Speed to market	5

Formula. Partner score = Σ (metric score / 10 × partner weight). Location score = Σ (metric score / 10 × location weight). Final = 50% × partner + 50% × location. If the brand runs the store (FOCO), half the operating-experience weight moves to financial readiness.

Money

17.5 PTS · CAN THEY PAY FOR IT, AND WILL IT PAY BACK?

Financial readiness

12.5 PTS · 25% OF PARTNER FIT

Can the partner fund the store? Investment is compared with the eyewear & optical setup cost for the city tier: ₹35L / ₹25L / ₹20L (Tier 1/2/3).

≥ 1.3× setup cost (has a working-capital buffer)	10
1.0–1.3×	7-9
0.75–1.0× — funding gap becomes a condition	4-6
50%–75%	2-4
Below 50% — rejected before scoring	0
Relies on a loan (from the notes)	-1

Real-estate economics

5 PTS · 10% OF LOCATION FIT

Will the store make money after rent? Capital cover plus whether the space is owned.

Capital ≥ 1.3× setup	9
≥ 1.0×	7
≥ 0.75×	5
Less	3
Owned space (no rent)	+1
Rented in a Tier 1 city	-0.5

Site readiness

15 PTS · IS THERE A SPACE THAT FITS THE FORMAT?

Floor & accessibility

7.5 PTS · 15% OF PARTNER FIT

Walk-in access. This format needs street-level visibility.

Ground floor	10
Mall unit (good fit for this category)	8
Upper floor / basement	2.5-3.5
No space yet (floor decided later)	5

Space size & format fit

5 PTS · 10% OF PARTNER FIT

Does the space fit the store format? Ideal 250–600 sq ft; workable 200–900.

250–600 sq ft	10
200–900 sq ft	7.5
Up to 20% outside that	5
Far too small or too big	2
No space yet	5

Space ownership

2.5 PTS · 5% OF PARTNER FIT

Who controls the space, and for how long.

Owned	10
Rented	7
Short-term lease	4
Not yet identified — caps the decision at Conditional	3

Operator

17.5 PTS · CAN THEY RUN THE STORE DAY TO DAY?

Operating experience

12.5 PTS · 25% OF PARTNER FIT

Can they run a shop? Years of retail experience, boosted when their business is related to eyewear & optical.

0 years	2
1 · 2 · 3 · 4 years	5 · 6 · 6.5 · 7
5–9 years	8
10+ years	8.5
Same trade / adjacent retail	+1.5 / +1
Owner not hands-on	−2

Local nuance & intent

5 PTS · 10% OF PARTNER FIT

Fit with local customers and staff, averaged with how serious the notes sound.

Kannada	10
English (Tier 1 / other)	7.5 / 6
Hindi (Tier 1 / other)	6 / 4
Notes show research · generic · any-brand	10 · 6.5 · 3

Location fit

45 PTS · IS THIS A PLACE THE BRAND WANTS TO BE?

Strategic fit & slots

10 PTS · 20% OF LOCATION FIT

How much the brand wants this territory now, and how many slots are left.

High priority, 2+ slots / 1 slot	10 / 8.5
Medium, 2+ / 1	7.5 / 6
Low, 2+ / 1	4 / 3
Outside the plan (fallback batch)	2

Demographic density

10 PTS · 20% OF LOCATION FIT

Population and spending power, from the city tier and the type of locality.

Tier 1 · 2 · 3 base	8 · 6.5 · 5
CBD / high street	+1.5
Transit, IT corridor, premium residential	+1
City fringe / industrial	−1.5 / −2

Purchase triggers (JTBD)

10 PTS · 20% OF LOCATION FIT

How strongly the spot triggers a purchase — busy streets, transit, malls.

Transit hub, CBD, high street	9
Mall unit	8.5
IT corridor · premium residential · residential	7.5 · 7 · 6
Fringe · industrial	4 · 3.5
Notes mention hospital, clinic, college…	+0.75 each

Supply-chain reach

5 PTS · 10% OF LOCATION FIT

How easily stock reaches the store from the existing network.

City already has stores (Bengaluru hub)	9–10
Nearest store city ≤ 120 km	8
≤ 250 km	6.5
Farther	4.5

Own-store overlap

5 PTS · 10% OF LOCATION FIT

Would it eat into one of the brand's own existing stores?

Own store under 2 km away	2
2–4 km	5
4–7 km	8
Farther, same city	9
New city, High priority / other	9.5 / 7.5

Competitors nearby

5 PTS · 10% OF LOCATION FIT

Other eyewear & optical businesses around the pin. A few prove there is demand; none is untested; too many split the customers. Read from the applicant's notes first, then an AI estimate for the pin, then the locality type.

A few (1–3) — demand proven, room to grow	9.5
None — white space (High-priority territory / other)	8 / 6.5
Several (4–7) — needs a clear edge	7
Crowded (8+) — saturated	3.5
No information	6.5

Launch realism

5 PTS · HOW SOON CAN THEY REALISTICALLY OPEN?

Speed to market

5 PTS · 10% OF PARTNER FIT

How soon they can open. Realistic lead time is ~2 months with a space, ~4 without.

≤ 3 months	10
4–6	7
7–9	4
10+	3
Faster than realistic (capped)	≤ 6
Stated deadline	+0.5

How a score becomes a decision.

LINE	VALUE	MEANING
Approve bar (tier minimum)	T1 70 · T2 66 · T3 62	Needed for a clean Approve; a slot holder below it is Conditional with a 90-day review.
Slot-eligible from	55	Can compete for a slot.
Review band	45–55	Hold for a human look.
Reject below	45	Too weak to proceed.
Capital floor	50%	Investment under this share of the tier minimum is rejected before scoring.
Cannibalisation radius	2 km	Own store closer than this scores 2/10 on competition.

Final decision

APPROVE	Won a slot, score ≥ tier bar, no conditions open.
CONDITIONAL	Won a slot but has conditions. **Cap rule:** no space identified caps the decision at Conditional (“Score 72 would be Approve, but no space is identified yet”). The slot is reserved for 60 days and the next in line is named.
ON HOLD	Waitlisted behind higher scores, lost the pin with no free pin left, outside the plan, review band, missing or conflicting data, legal risk, duplicate, or 3+ major gaps.
REJECT	Failed a knockout or scored below 45.

Conditions the engine can attach

CONDITION	TRIGGER	MAJOR GAP?	DUE
Secure a ground-floor 250–600 sq ft space in the pin	No space yet	yes	60 days
Close a funding gap (sanction letter or co-investor)	Capital 50–100% of minimum	yes	30 days
Move to a ground-floor or mall unit	Upper floor when walk-ins matter	yes	45 days
Find a right-sized space / get format sign-off	Far outside / slightly outside the size range	yes / no	45 / 14 days
Relocate to free pin X	Lost own pin but outranks the territory	no	30 days
Reset the launch to month N	Faster than the realistic lead time	no	3 days
Name a full-time store manager	Owner not hands-on (from notes)	no	21 days
Needs a running shop	Shop-in-shop / micro model without one	yes	21 days
Confirm size / notes / conflict	Missing size, values read from notes, soft AI conflict	no	7 days
Team must open a territory	Scenario B fallback	no	21 days
90-day performance review	Slot holder below the tier bar	no	after opening

One store per pin; the best partners win the slots.

1. **Usable slots** per territory = min(open slots, pins without an existing store). A pin listed in two territories counts for the higher-priority one.
2. **Pin contest.** Among eligible applications on the same pin, the best score keeps it.
3. **Relocation.** Each runner-up is re-scored on every free pin of its territory (preferring pins no one else asked for). If its best re-score still clears 55, it joins the slot race with a “relocate” condition.
4. **Slot race.** Pin holders and relocated runners-up are ranked by score; tie-break capital → site readiness → sooner launch → lower ID. The top N take the N usable slots; the rest are waitlisted with their rank, and the first is named “next in line” on the slot holders.
5. **Proximity check.** Two new stores closer than 2 km get a catchment-overlap flag.

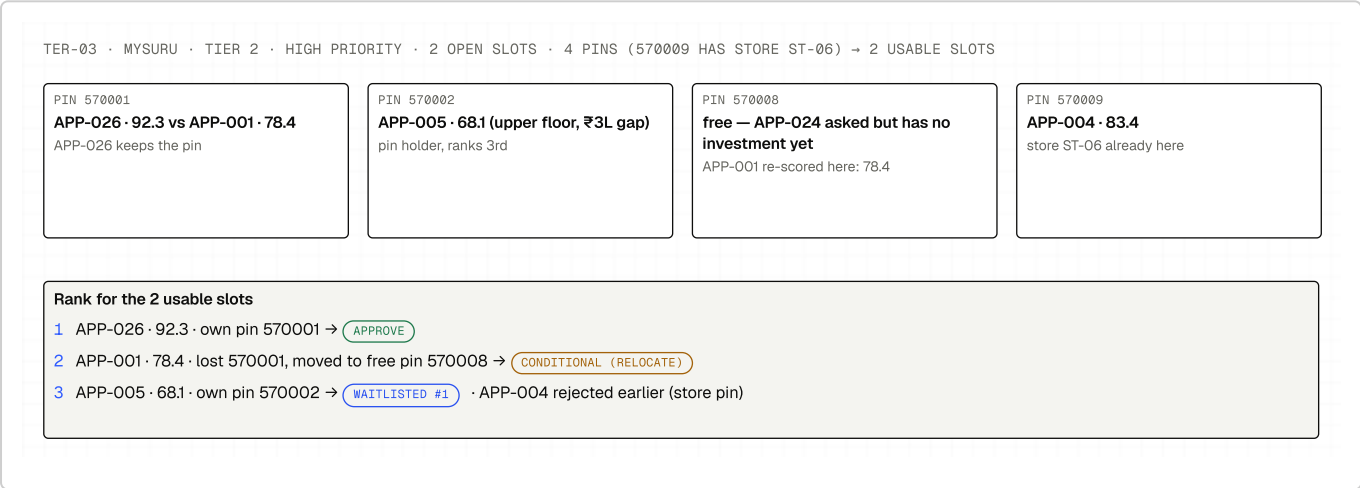


FIG. 03 · REAL ALLOCATION FROM THE SAMPLE BATCH, TERRITORY TER-03 MYSURU.

What every partner gets.

Decision & headline	One status and a one-sentence reason (slot, rival, bar, cap).
Five dimension scores	Plus all 14 metric scores with the evidence the engine recorded.
Conditions	What must close before signing, with due dates.
Path to yes	Single changes (and the combination) simulated against the whole batch — rivals included — showing the decision each would produce.
Open pins nearby	For anyone without a slot: free pins in the same city that still have capacity.
Explanation & partner message	AI-written plain-language reason for the team; a message to the partner in Kannada, Hindi or English. Template text from the scores if AI is unavailable.
Onboarding plan	Dated steps in four phases (Before signing · Set up · Train · Open), owner per step, training at the nearest existing store, translated into the partner's language.
Indicative payback	Setup cost ÷ (tier revenue benchmark × margin, + rent saved if owned).
Interview checklist	Not in the data and not scored: proof of funds, credit, people management, local knowledge, brand fit, coachability.

Plan timing rules

Offer letter day 5 · KYC day 10 · site audit day 14 (or site found by day 60 if no space) · agreement 7 days later · fit-out 5 weeks (≤600 sq ft), 7 (≤1,200) or 9 weeks · licences agreement + 21 days · hire 4 staff 3 weeks before handover · owner training 13 days at the nearest store · soft launch 2 days after fit-out · grand opening on the target date if feasible, otherwise a week after soft launch · 30-day review with a “ready to run alone” sign-off · 90-day review. A festival deadline (e.g. Diwali, 8 Nov 2026) is checked against the plan.

Example: APP-016 (Approve, Davanagere)

PHASE	DATE	STEP	OWNER
Set up	2026-10-30	Offer letter and LOI in Kannada	Brand
Set up	2026-11-04	KYC and proof of funds	Partner
Set up	2026-11-08	Site audit and layout sign-off	Brand
Set up	2026-11-15	Franchise agreement signed, fee paid	Both
Set up	2026-11-18	Fit-out starts (5 weeks)	Brand
Train	2026-12-02	Hire 4 staff	Partner
Set up	2026-12-06	Licences in hand	Partner
Train	2026-12-07	Owner training at ST-09 (Hubballi-Dharwad, ~130 km) — 13 days in Kannada	Both
Train	2026-12-18	Staff training in Kannada	Brand
Open	2026-12-19	Stock, point of sale and systems go live	Brand

PHASE	DATE	STEP	OWNER
Open	2026-12-25	Soft launch	Both
Open	2027-01-24	Grand opening	Both
Open	2027-02-23	30-day review and "ready to run alone" sign-off	Brand
Open	2027-04-24	90-day review	Brand

Fits the partner's 3-month target. Indicative payback ≈ 22 months (₹20L setup, ~₹0.9L/month operating profit).

Ask why. Say what changed. See who moves.

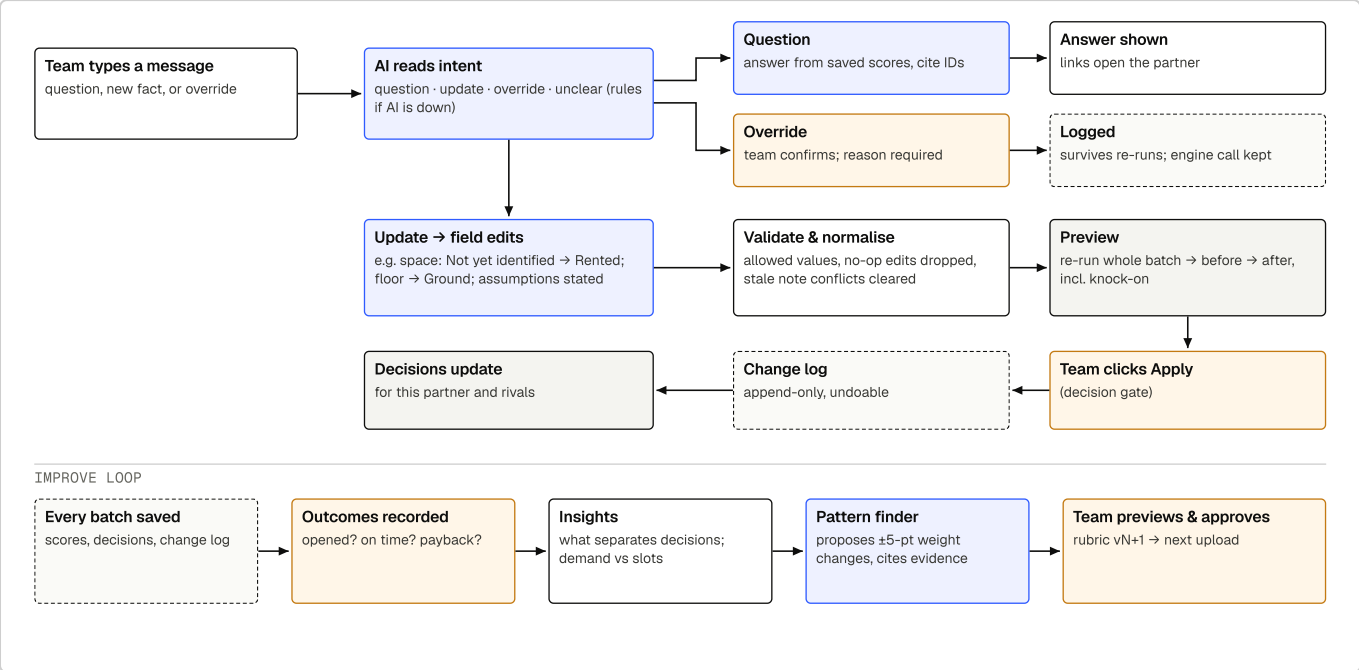


FIG. 04 · THE CHAT LOOP (TOP) AND THE IMPROVE LOOP (BOTTOM). ORANGE BOXES ARE DECISION GATES: NOTHING CHANGES UNTIL THE TEAM CONFIRMS.

- **Event-sourced data.** The uploaded file is never modified; every change is an edit on top of it, so any decision can be traced to the exact facts that produced it, and any change can be undone.
- **Whole-batch re-runs.** One update can change rivals' decisions (e.g. a withdrawal frees a slot and the next in line moves up); the preview shows those knock-on changes before Apply.
- **Upgrades from Reject** are tagged “team to confirm”.
- **Rubric versions.** The pattern finder proposes changes of at most 5 points per weight, says when evidence is thin (< 5 recorded outcomes), and keeps each group at 100. The team previews the impact on the current batch and approves version N+1.

The AI reads and writes. It never decides.

JOB	MODEL	CAN IT CHANGE A SCORE?	IF IT FAILS
Tag free text (relevance, urgency, red flags, contradictions, values for blank cells)	Gemini 3.6 Flash, temperature 0	Indirectly, via tags; a keyword match on the brand's own trade is a floor; AI flags can only Hold, never Reject	Rule-based reader
Place unmapped pin codes	Gemini 3.6 Flash	Locality type only, labelled “AI estimate”; coordinates rejected if outside the city	Built-in map / city baseline
Custom brand profile (“Other”)	Gemini 3.7 Flash	Sets numbers the team reviews before upload; values clamped	Closest preset
Explain a decision; partner message; translate the plan	Gemini 3.7 / 3.6 Flash	No — told the numbers are final	Template from the scores
Chat: answer “why”, turn facts into edits, detect overrides	Gemini 3.7 Flash	No — edits go back through validation and the engine; team confirms	Rule-based chat
Pattern finder	Gemini 3.7 Flash	No — produces a draft rubric for approval	Unavailable message

Every call is JSON-only with a hard timeout and falls through three models (3.7 Flash → 3.6 Flash → 3.5 Flash-Lite). The key lives on the server only.

One partner, end to end.

APP-012 · Anil Kulkarni — Davanagere 577002 (TER-07, Tier 3, High priority, 3 slots). ₹18L to invest, 2 years as an eyewear-chain sales manager, no space yet, wants to open in 2 months, prefers Kannada. Notes: “Looking for a shop near the PB Road market”.

Decision on upload

CONDITIONAL **66.2/100** (partner 61.3 · location 71.1)

Holds slot 2 of 3 in TER-07 (score 66.2) if 3 conditions are met. Score 66.2 would be Approve, but no space is identified yet, so Conditional — slot reserved for 60 days.

Conditions

- Secure a ground-floor 250–600 sq ft space in pin 577002 within 60 days (slot reserved meanwhile); the brand's site team audits it.
- Close a funding gap of ₹2L (sanction letter or co-investor) before signing.
- Reset the launch to month 4; 2 months are too fast without a space in hand.

Path to yes (simulated)

- All of: secures a ground-floor 425 sq ft space (rented); raises capital to ₹26L → **Approve** (83.5)

After “APP-012 has found a 450 sq ft ground-floor space”

CONDITIONAL **75.5/100**

Holds slot 2 of 3 in TER-07 (score 75.5) if 1 condition is met.

DIMENSION	BEFORE	AFTER
Money	51	51
Site readiness	47	95
Operator	81	81
Location fit	73	73
Launch realism	60	100

Remaining condition: Close a funding gap of ₹2L (sanction letter or co-investor) before signing.

All 14 metrics on upload

METRIC	WEIGHT	SCORE /10	EVIDENCE THE ENGINE RECORDED
Floor & accessibility	15	5	No space yet — the brand will require a ground-floor site.
Space size & format fit	10	5	No space yet — to be sourced at the 250–600 sq ft prototype.
Space ownership	5	3	No space secured yet.
Financial readiness	25	5.2	₹18L vs Tier 3 minimum ₹20L (0.90×) · batch median ₹30L.
Operating experience	25	8	2 years running a shop; directly relevant (Ex-sales manager at an eyewear chain).
Speed to market	10	6	Wants to open in 2 months — faster than the ~4 months needed without a space.
Local nuance & intent	10	8.3	Kannada matches local customers and staff; notes show generic intent.
Strategic fit & slots	20	10	TER-07 (Davanagere) is High priority with 3 open slots.
Demographic density	20	5	Tier 3 city; Davanagere · 577002 — not mapped.

METRIC	WEIGHT	SCORE /10	EVIDENCE THE ENGINE RECORDED
Purchase triggers (JTBD)	20	6.8	Purchase-trigger strength: not mapped; near market.
Supply-chain reach	10	6.5	No store in Davanagere yet; nearest is Hubballi-Dharwad (ST-09) ~171 km by road — needs a modified delivery schedule.
Real-estate economics	10	5	Capital covers 90% of setup; rent not yet known.
Own-store overlap	10	9.5	White space — no own store in Davanagere yet, and it is a High-priority territory.
Competitors nearby	10	6.5	No competitor information for this pin — neutral score.

Knock-on example: “APP-019 has withdrawn”

ID	BEFORE	AFTER	WHY
APP-007	CONDITIONAL	APPROVE	Wins slot 1 of 2 in TER-06; score 88.5 clears the Tier 3 bar of 62.
ROW-018	ON HOLD	CONDITIONAL	Holds slot 2 of 2 in TER-06 (score 70.8) if 1 condition is met.
APP-019	APPROVE	WITHDRAWN	Withdrawn by the applicant.

The whole sample batch

Sample batch (28 rows seeded with the brief's edge cases): APPROVE 6 · CONDITIONAL 5 · ON HOLD 12 · REJECT 5. 11 of 12 usable slots filled; 3 pins contested.

TERRITORY	PRIORITY	SLOTS → USABLE	ALLOCATED	WAITLIST	NOTE
TER-01 Bengaluru	High	2 → 2	APP-002, APP-003	APP-018	Over-subscribed 2× — 1 qualified partner waitlisted. Consider adding slots.
TER-02 Bengaluru	Medium	1 → 1	APP-010	APP-009	Over-subscribed 2× — 1 qualified partner waitlisted. Consider adding slots.
TER-03 Mysuru	High	2 → 2	APP-026, APP-001	APP-005	Over-subscribed 2.5× — 1 qualified partner waitlisted. Consider adding slots.
TER-04 Mangaluru	Medium	1 → 1	APP-014	APP-023	Over-subscribed 3× — 1 qualified partner waitlisted. Consider adding slots.
TER-05 Hubballi-Dharwad	Low	1 → 1	APP-020	—	Filled.
TER-06 Tumakuru	High	2 → 2	APP-019, APP-007	ROW-018	Over-subscribed 1.5× — 1 qualified partner waitlisted. Consider adding slots.
TER-07 Davanagere	High	3 → 3	APP-016, APP-012	—	1 slot still open: 3 applied but not all qualified.
TER-08 Belagavi	Low	2 → 0	—	—	No capacity: every listed pin already has a store. 2 applicants asked for nearby pins 590006, 590010 — consider adding them.

What the numbers rest on.

- **Tier minimums and space ranges** are benchmarks (eyewear: Lenskart's published ~₹35L regular / ~₹20L “Lite” formats, 250–600 sq ft), not given in the case. The team can tune them before upload.
- **Score cut-offs** (tier bars 70/66/62, review band 45–55) are starting values to be tuned against which partners actually open and pay back.
- **No store performance data.** Sheet 3 has no sales or payback, so existing stores are assumed healthy; payback is a category benchmark.
- **No geography below pin code.** About 60 well-known pins are on a built-in locality map; others use an AI estimate or the city baseline. Distances are approximate.
- **Competitors nearby** (new in rubric v2) has no uploaded competitor list: it uses the applicant's own notes when they mention competitors, otherwise an AI estimate for the pin code (labelled), otherwise the locality type. Public OpenStreetMap servers were tested but were too unreliable to depend on.
- **Preferred language** counts in “local nuance” (10% of partner fit), following the team's applicant rubric.
- **Financial strength beyond stated investment** and traits like coachability are checked in the interview, not scored.

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